

# What Engineering Taught Me

*Madhukar V*

*For every first-year student who thinks there is still plenty of time. There's less than you think, and it's enough if you start now.*

*Madhukar*

EMPEIRYA

# What Engineering Taught Me

*Lessons from four years, written by*

Madhukar V

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# I

# Skills

> *"Four years is enough time to become genuinely useful to an industry, as long as you don't drift."*

Week 7 · answered by voice · 5 min

# The goal I nearly lost

*Engineering, years one to four*

### WHAT HAPPENED

Engineering gives you four years and a hundred reasons to spend them on something else: marks for their own sake, trends, whatever everyone around you is doing.

### WHAT I FELT

Busy, but unsure it was leading anywhere. Being busy felt like progress. It isn't the same thing.

### WHAT I TRIED

I kept coming back to one question: what can I build that a real company would need?

### WHAT I LEARNED

*Never divert from the goal. Use the four years to build real industry skills. Everything else can wait; this can't.*

### WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

Start building real things in the first year, not the last one.

### IF YOU'RE STARTING NOW

Every semester, ask yourself: what can I do today that I couldn't do six months ago?

**Hear it in his voice**
Scan to play the recording this page came from.

# II

# People

> *"Build a network of good friends who have a vision and actually work for it. They will pull you forward for the rest of your life."*

Week 12 · written

# Open on your first day of college




*For the next engineer in the family*

*In the app, this letter stays sealed until that day. In print, it comes as a tucked-in envelope.*



EMPEIRYA

*Printed for Madhukar V*